Illustration with synthetic congestion and weather, to show each port status. Not a real forecast.

Port Brief

Port and shipping conditions for UK importers, forwarders and logistics teams

Issue 12, Sunday 11 October 2026

Felixstowe congested as wind threatens London Gateway on Wednesday

Disruption likely: London Gateway and Hamburg. Congested: Felixstowe and Bremerhaven. Watch: Liverpool and Rotterdam. Rough seas in the Bay of Biscay may delay Asia, Mediterranean and West Africa services into the UK by 1–2 days. Reliability: Sea-Intelligence 49.9%, Xeneta 29%.

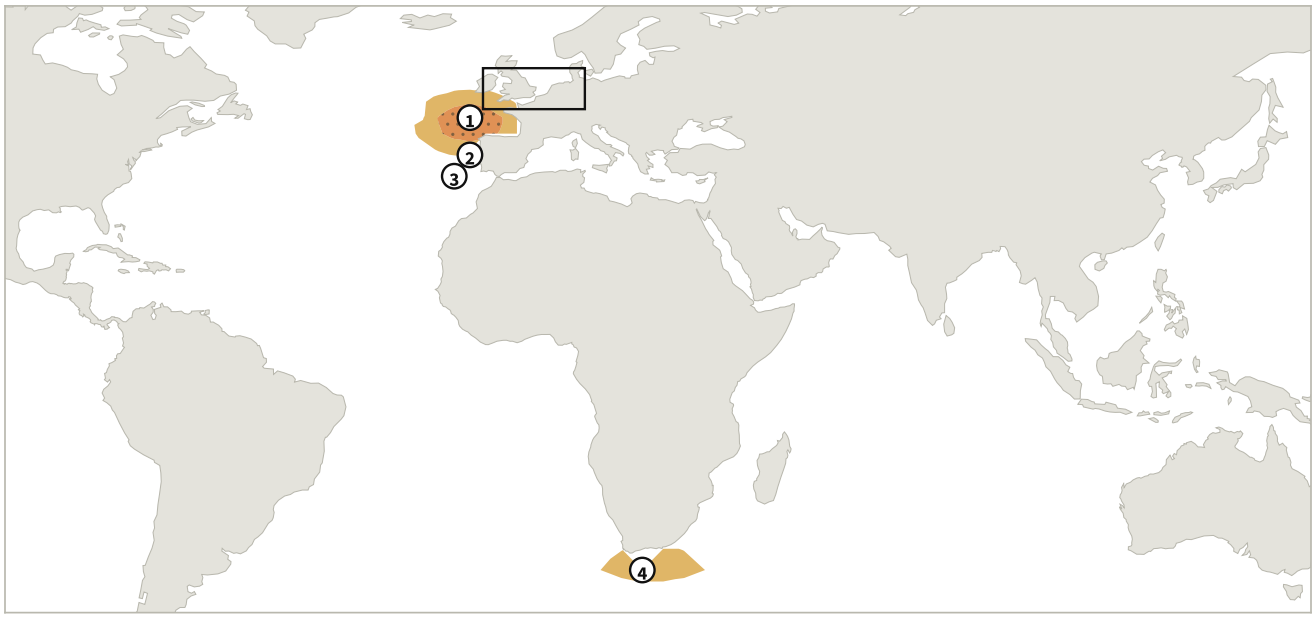
The ports this week

Port	Status	What to do	Detail
United Kingdom			
Felixstowe	Congested	Berths are 13 points busier than normal. Add 2–3 days to inland plans for containers arriving in the next 2 weeks, pre-book haulage and check your free time.	Berths 84% occupied, +13 points on normal. Median stay 38 hours.
Southampton	Running normally	Running as expected with no predicted delays. Speak to your carrier about release and delivery now.	Berths 61% occupied, +1 points on normal. Median stay 22 hours.
London Gateway	Disruption likely	Crane stoppages likely on Wednesday from 11:00 to 20:00, with gusts to 22 m/s. Tell your haulier to expect longer waits and allow 24–48 hours on collections.	Windy spell: Wed 11:00–20:00, 22 m/s Berths 66% occupied, +2 points on normal. Median stay 25 hours.
Liverpool	Watch	Cranes may pause on Thursday morning. Allow 12–24 hours and avoid tight Thursday cut-offs.	Windy spell: Thu 07:00–13:00, 16 m/s Berths 58% occupied, -3 points on normal. Median stay 20 hours.
North Europe			
Rotterdam	Watch	Berths are 7 points busier than usual. If you tranship here, watch berthing times and avoid tight feeder connections.	Berths 74% occupied, +7 points on normal. Median stay 31 hours.
Antwerp	Running normally	Running as expected with no predicted delays. Speak to your carrier about release and delivery now.	Berths 63% occupied, +0 points on normal. Median stay 28 hours.
Bremerhaven	Congested	Ships are spending 36% longer in port than usual. Add 2–3 days to inland plans for containers arriving in the next 2 weeks and pre-book haulage.	Berths 70% occupied, +4 points on normal. Median stay 45 hours.
Hamburg	Disruption likely	A 24-hour strike is reported for Monday. Check your terminal's latest notice before booking collections and allow 24–48 hours.	Berths 68% occupied, +3 points on normal. Median stay 30 hours.

Weather times are UK local time. Buffers follow the Port Brief playbook and assume normal carrier free time.

Weather on the routes into Europe

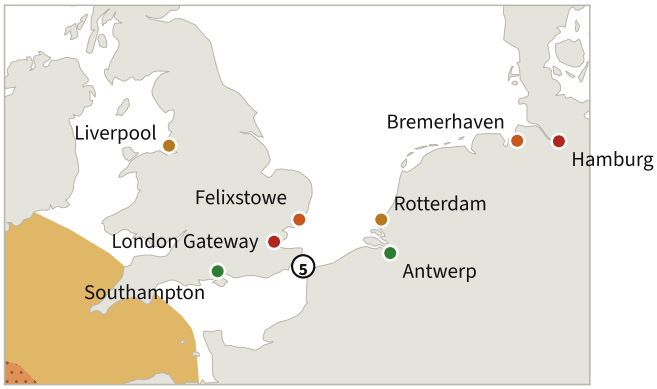
Two storms matter for European arrivals. Biscay turns severe on Wednesday and Thursday, so services from Asia, the Mediterranean and West Africa into the UK are likely to run 1–2 days late. Ships rounding the Cape on Friday may lose up to 1 day. Don't book haulage against the published ETA.



Highest seas over the next six days: Rough 4 m+, Severe 6 m+, Extreme 8 m+. Numbers refer to the table below. The box is the ports map.

No.	Sea area	Severity	When	Peak seas	Expected delay
1	**Western Approaches** Transatlantic and Cape-routed Asia arrivals into the Channel	Severe	Wed 14 Oct	7.3 m	1–2 days
2	**Bay of Biscay** Asia, Mediterranean and West Africa services into the UK	Severe	Wed 14 Oct	7.0 m	1–2 days
3	**Off Portugal** Asia, Mediterranean and West Africa services into the UK	Severe	Wed 14 Oct	6.6 m	1–2 days
4	**Cape of Good Hope / Agulhas** Asia–North Europe services routed via the Cape	Rough	Wed 14 Oct	5.4 m	Up to 1 day
5	**Dover Strait** All Channel traffic and North Sea feeders	Rough	Wed 14 Oct	2.2 m	Up to 1 day

North European ports



Ports coloured by this week's status: running normally, watch, congested, disruption likely.

Forecast changes since the last issue

Liverpool, Tue 13 Oct: gusts 14 to 22 m/s

London Gateway, Fri 16 Oct: gusts 19 to 14 m/s

Six-day forecast at the ports

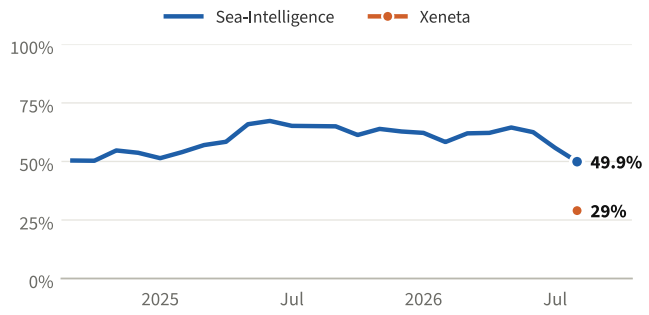
Peak gusts (m/s) and sea (m)	Mon 12	Tue 13	Wed 14	Thu 15	Fri 16	Sat 17	Sun 18
Felixstowe	**15 / 0.9**	14 / 0.9	9 / 0.6	11 / 0.9	12 / 0.7	12 / 1.0	13 / 1.4
Southampton	**16 / 1.3**	**16 / 1.4**	11 / 0.6	12 / 0.9	14 / 1.0	13 / 0.7	14 / 1.3
London Gateway	13 / 0.6	14 / 0.7	9 / 0.4	10 / 0.6	14 / 0.7	15 / 1.5	14 / 2.0
Liverpool	14 / 0.7	**22 / 1.6**	13 / 1.1	15 / 1.1	14 / 1.3	12 / 1.1	10 / 0.4
Rotterdam	13 / 0.6	**15 / 1.3**	12 / 1.0	10 / 0.7	**16 / 1.3**	**18 / 1.7**	12 / 1.5
Antwerp	12 / 0.6	**18 / 1.3**	13 / 0.9	9 / 0.6	**19 / 1.4**	**18 / 1.9**	**15 / 1.8**
Bremerhaven	8 / 0.6	**17 / 1.4**	**18 / 1.5**	11 / 0.9	14 / 1.3	**18 / 1.9**	**16 / 1.6**
Hamburg	9 / 0.8	**18 / 1.8**	**19 / 1.9**	12 / 1.1	14 / 1.5	**18 / 2.2**	**16 / 1.7**

Shaded amber where gusts reach 15 m/s or seas reach 2.5 m, when crane work or pilot boarding may pause; red from 20 m/s or 3.5 m, when it usually stops. Days run midnight to midnight UTC.

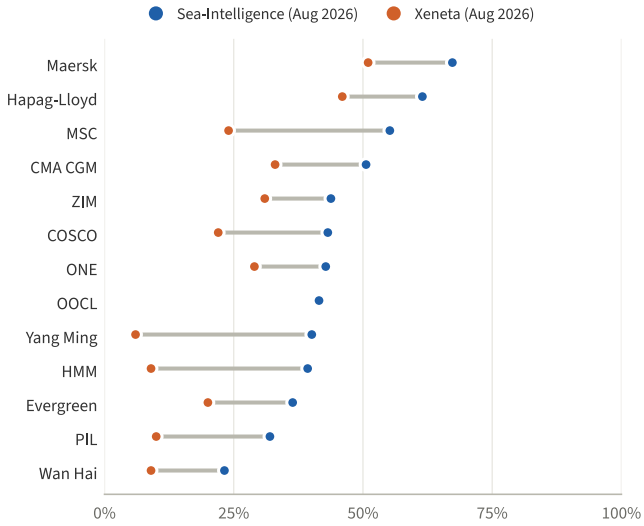
Schedule reliability

Sea-Intelligence puts global schedule reliability at 49.9% for August 2026, 5.9 points down on the month before. Xeneta measures 29% for August 2026. The two benchmarks sit 20.9 points apart because they define on time differently. Use them as two views of the same trend.

Share of ships arriving on time, worldwide



The same carriers, measured two ways, Aug 2026



Carrier	Sea-Intelligence, Aug 2026	Xeneta, Aug 2026	Difference, points
Maersk	67.3%	51%	+16
Hapag-Lloyd	61.5%	46%	+16
MSC	55.2%	24%	+31
CMA CGM	50.6%	33%	+18
ZIM	43.8%	31%	+13
COSCO	43.2%	22%	+21
ONE	42.8%	29%	+14
OOCL	41.5%	Not ranked	
Yang Ming	40.1%	6%	+34
HMM	39.3%	9%	+30
Evergreen	36.4%	20%	+16
PIL	32.0%	10%	+22
Wan Hai	23.2%	9%	+14

Sea-Intelligence counts an arrival as on time if it is within one day of schedule (34 trade lanes, 60+ carriers). Late ships arrived 6.81 days behind schedule on average.

Xeneta counts only arrivals on the scheduled day. Xeneta ranks 12 carriers (OOCL is not listed separately).

Notices from ports and carriers

Operational notices from the past week from the ports and carriers we follow. Items marked NEW did not appear in a previous issue.

Port of Rotterdam

Smart berths: What West African ports can learn from Rotterdam
Businessday NG, Thu 8 Oct. New since the last issue

Maersk

Maersk raises U.S. surcharge to USD 215: what it means for Maersk stock
ad-hoc-news.de, Mon 12 Oct. New since the last issue

Maersk raises U.S. inland fuel surcharge to USD 215: stock pre-market at EUR 3,335.50
ad-hoc-news.de, Mon 12 Oct. New since the last issue

Maersk raises U.S. inland haulage fuel surcharge to USD 215 per container
Data Portuaria, Mon 12 Oct. New since the last issue

MSC

Agility bags EUR 500 mn financing + Damietta welcomes another MSC service
EnterpriseAM, Sun 11 Oct. New since the last issue

MSC launches weekly feeder service to Lekki Port via Lomé
Businessday NG, Sun 11 Oct. New since the last issue

MSC added its weekly Himalaya services at Damietta, its second new call there in recent months
EnterpriseAM, Sat 10 Oct. New since the last issue

Hapag-Lloyd

Hapag-Lloyd suspends bookings to three Philippine ports as container crisis deepens
Splash247, Mon 12 Oct. New since the last issue

Hapag-Lloyd adds Luanda equipment surcharge
Container News, Sat 10 Oct. New since the last issue

MSC and ONE to continue Asia-South America service without Hapag-Lloyd
FreshPlaza, Fri 9 Oct. New since the last issue

CMA CGM

CMA CGM: Malaysia Enforces New Cargo Manifest Rules, Raising Risk of Port Delays
Breakbulk.News, Fri 9 Oct. New since the last issue

Nigerian Importers Face Third CMA CGM Shipping Surcharge in 2026
Ships & Ports, Fri 9 Oct. New since the last issue

CMA CGM raises West Africa surcharges and updates Mogadishu PSS
Container News, Thu 8 Oct. New since the last issue

How to read this brief. Weather flags are forecasts, not port notices: they mark the hours when wind or sea is likely to reach the levels at which terminals usually pause crane work or pilots stop boarding. Always confirm with your terminal or carrier before changing plans.

Sources. Headlines link to the original publishers; some discovered via Google News. Port congestion data: Sinay (sinay.ai). Schedule reliability: Sea-Intelligence Global Liner Performance report; Xeneta Schedule Reliability Scorecard. Tropical cyclone data: GDACS (Global Disaster Alert and Coordination System), European Commission JRC / UN OCHA. Weather data by Open-Meteo.com (CC BY 4.0). Maps use Natural Earth data.

Data this issue. weather: complete; storm_field: complete; tropical storms: complete; congestion: not connected; schedule reliability: complete; notices: complete.